

Visit of UNICEF's Representative of the Pouss displacement site, Maga, Mayo-Danay



Registration of potential beneficiaries for the multi-purpose cash response in Maga

UNICEF CAMEROON FLASH UPDATE N°5: FLOODS - FAR NORTH
24 OCTOBER 2024

HUMANITARIAN OVERVIEW[1]

People in the Far North continue to be severely affected by the floods. According to the Regional Delegation of Health, 68,285 households, approximately 409,710 people, including 139,651 children under 5 and 29,428 pregnant women, were affected by the floods, as of 11 October 2024.[2]

Households affected	Children under 5 affected	Pregnant women affected
68,285	139,651	29,428

Some 56,084 houses were destroyed or damaged, 262 schools flooded, 65 health centres affected, and 82,509 of farmland flooded.[3] After the rains, the rising river levels are causing concerns about a worsening situation in the coming days and weeks. The progressive rise in groundwater levels and the river overflowing continue in the Logone et Chari division, increasing the risk of river flooding. At the beginning of October, people affected by floods in Logone et Chari started to displace to areas considered flood secure. Some 9,747 people (1,527 households) were registered in host families and spontaneous sites in Kousseri between 2 and 9 October,[4] with an additional 4,054 people (576 households) reported in different locations in Logone et Chari between 16 and 21 October.[5]

The Government, local authorities/elites, and a variety of humanitarian organizations are providing assistance to those affected.[6]

UNICEF'S RESPONSE

Health



- **130,015 people vaccinated against cholera**, including **22,500 children aged 1 to 4 years** in the localities of Yagoua, Vélé and Maga, Mayo-Danay. 99.57 per cent of the targeted 130,572 people were reached during this preventive campaign.
- **2 cholera management kits** were prepositioned, one in the Far North and one in the North region, to anticipate a potential outbreak of the disease.
- **12,353 patients received health services** with UNICEF's support, in the Yagoua, Kaikai, Vele, (Mayo-Danay), Mada and Blagoua (Logone-et-Chari) health districts.
- Provision of **supplies for disease management**, including 3,000 boxes of paracetamol, 2,500 boxes of oral rehydration salts, 1,000 rapid diagnostic tests for malaria, 10 rapid diagnostic tests for cholera, medication for malaria treatment and other diseases, and 500 boxes of medical gloves in the most affected divisions (Mayo-Danay and Logone-et-Chari).

A child is being vaccinated by a UNICEF staff in Yagoua Health District, @UNICEF2024

[1] For more information on the context, please see the Flash Update No 1, Flash Update No 2, Flash Update 3.
[2] Regional Delegation of Health, Far North, Flood situation report No 4, covering 25 September to 11 October 2024.
[3] Source OCHA, flood snapshot, as of 19 September: https://reliefweb.int/report/cameroon/cameroun-extreme-nord-apercu-des-inondations-au-19-septembre-2024, regional delegation of health, regional delegations of basic and secondary education.
[4] Emergency Tracking Tool, Dashboard No 108, data collected between 2 and 9 October, IOM: Cameroun — Suivi des urgences 108 (02 -09 Octobre 2024) | Displacement Tracking Matrix.
[5] Emergency Tracking Tool, Dashboard No 109, data collected between 16 and 21 October, IOM: Cameroun — Suivi des urgences 109 (16-21Octobre 2024) | Displacement Tracking Matrix
[6] OCHA is coordinating and providing information on the humanitarian response. Information on response activities is available in the Far North flood overview as of 3 October: Cameroun : Extrême-Nord - Aperçu des inondations (Au 3 octobre 2024) - Cameroon | ReliefWeb and the OCHA Information Note on the floods in the Far North as of 19 September: Cameroun - Extrême-Nord : Note d'information sur les inondations (Au 19 septembre 2024) - Cameroon | ReliefWeb

WASH	• **500 WASH kits** distributed in the IDPs sites in Kousseri on 24 October. • Support provided for the construction of **10 emergency latrines for 100 households in IDPs sites** in Palia, Maga, (4) and in Madagascar, Kousseri (6). Identification of other locations for the construction of emergency latrines in Kousseri IDP sites is ongoing. • Identification and **diagnosis of non-functional water points** in areas affected by flooding in Kousseri, Maga and Yagoua ongoing. • Previously, **1,430 WASH kits** were distributed in Vele and Yagoua (Mayo-Danay) and in Mayo-Sangué (Mayo-Tsanaga). In addition, **734 packs of 300 tablets of aquatabs each** were distributed to households in Maga (Mayo-Danay). Distributions were accompanied by key messages on good hygiene practices.
Education	• **560 WASH and dignity kits**[7] and **10 educational kits**[8] were distributed to schools in Blangoua, Darak, Kousséri, Logone-Birni, Makary, Waza, and Zina. • **19 tents** were installed in Yagoua, Maga, (Mayo-Danay), Zina and Makary (Logon-et-Chari) to provide safe space for education and child protection activities.
Child Protection	• **1,019 children** affected by the floods received mental health and psychosocial support through mobile child-friendly spaces and sport activities in Maga (Mayo-Danay) and in Logone Birni and Fotokol (Logone-et-Chari), 406 children during the week of 14 October. • **34 children** received case management, including family counselling on managing children with special needs. • **A rapid assessment of the needs of children** affected by the floods was carried out in all the subdivisions of Mayo-Danay and Logone-et-Chari. The report is being finalized.
Nutrition	• **15,050 cartons of Ready-to-Use Therapeutic Food (RUTF)** and **500 cartons of therapeutic milk** were prepositioned in various hospitals and warehouses in the Mayo-Danay and Logone-et-Chari divisions. • **2,961 SAM children were admitted** to the programmes and were successfully treated in August and September in health districts affected by the floods (Bogo, Mada, Maga, Vele, Yagoua (Mayo-Danay), Fotokol, Goulfey, Kousseri, Makary (Logone-et-Chari)).
Multi-purpose Cash	• **1,300 most vulnerable households** out of the 8,664 households registered are targeted for a three-month multi-purpose cash plus[9] response.[10] • Payment started with **128 households** the week of 21 October.
SBC/ AAP[11]	• Training of **17 community health workers and 16 U-reporters**[12] on PSEA,[13] AAP, PFE,[14] resilience to climate change. • Focus group discussions on Essential Family Practices (cholera prevention, hygiene, vaccinations, exclusive breastfeeding up to 6 months, etc.), the use of feedback mechanisms and the use of cash held in Maga.

[7] The WASH and dignity kits for schools include WASH supplies, a torch, supplies to support menstrual hygiene, and education materials about proper hygiene practices.
[8] The educational kits, also called "school in a box", are for 40 students and one teacher and are made of 42 components, including basic school supplies such as exercise books, pencils, chalk, etc, teaching aids, and a blackboard.
[9] Cash plus is when cash transfers provided to people facing crises are combined with other complementary forms of assistance. In this case, cash interventions will be accompanied by social behaviour change communications.
[10] The transfer amount is following the defined household monthly Minimum Expenditure Basket (MEB) of 57,000 XAF. Please see Flash Update No 2 for information on targeting criteria.
[11] Social Behaviour Change (SBC); Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP)
[12] U-Report is a social platform available on Facebook, Twitter, and on SMS, developed by UNICEF, available in 50 countries globally. The platform allows young people to express themselves on issues dear to them. The objective of U-Report is to amplify the voices of young people to allow them to participate in the public debate, to express their views on social issues that affect them and thus to find solutions to the problems they face. More information is available on UNICEF lance U-Report, une plate-forme sociale pour amplifier la voix des jeunes | UNICEF
[13] Prevention of Sexual Exploitation and Abuse
[14] Participation, Feedback and Engagement


Community sensitization in Maga




U-Reporters in Guirvidig

Youth Participation

- On 17 October in Maroua, 30 young people from several associations joined the Maroua U-Report community, accompanied by the Maroua 1er Town Hall and the deputy sub-prefect of Maroua 1er, to clean out the newly-built gutters, which were clogged with household rubbish and plastic waste.
- On 23 October, the U-Reporters of Maga supported the flooded health centre of Guirvidig in the Maga District, creating sandbag barriers to protect the centre from further water damage. https://www.facebook.com/share/v/bxiWQFfAecVCT38s/

Coordination

- UNICEF is coordinating the **WASH, Nutrition, Child Protection and Education sector** response.
- UNICEF is coordinating its response within the intersectoral coordination frameworks.

KEY PLANNING FIGURES AND FINANCIAL NEEDS

WASH (SECTOR)	**EDUCATION** (SECTOR)	**CHILD PROTECTION** (WG)[15]	**NUTRITION** (SECTOR)	**HEALTH** (UNICEF)
TARGET 223K BUDGET $3.3M	**TARGET 42K BUDGET $1.1M**	**TARGET 66K BUDGET $1.6M**	**TARGET 2.3K BUDGET $211k**	**TARGET 65.8K BUDGET $270k**
To provide sustainable access to safe water and adequate basic sanitation, and critical WASH supplies.	To provide temporary learning spaces, educational supplies for students and teachers, and WASH supplies for schools.	To provide case management, referrals, mental health and psychosocial support, recreational and dignity kits and to strengthen community-based protection mechanisms.	To provide the full package of prevention and care for severely malnourished children.	To procure and preposition supplies, facilitate the roll-out of the cholera vaccination and to support the community health workers and health practitioners in the flood affected health districts.

UNICEF is thankful to **SIDA[16] and FCDO**[17] for their **$840,000 in flexible funding and to CERF[18]** which allocated **$1,360,000 for a rapid WASH and Education response** in flood affected areas. Furthermore, UNICEF was able to mobilize **$195,000 of its regular funds** for the flood response.

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[15] Sector Working Group
[16] Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency
[17] Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office
[18] Central Emergency Response Fund